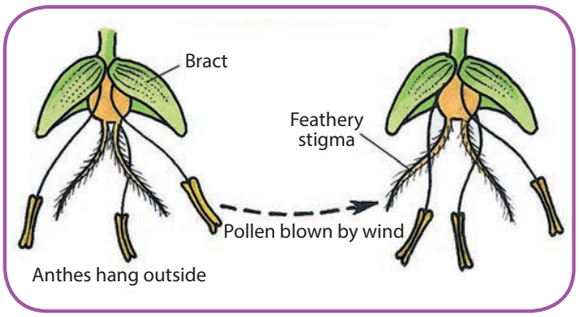
In self pollination, seeds produce weak plants and new varities of plants cannot be produced. In cross pollination, seeds produce good plants and new verities of plants can be produced. Pollination takes place through different agents. They are explained below.

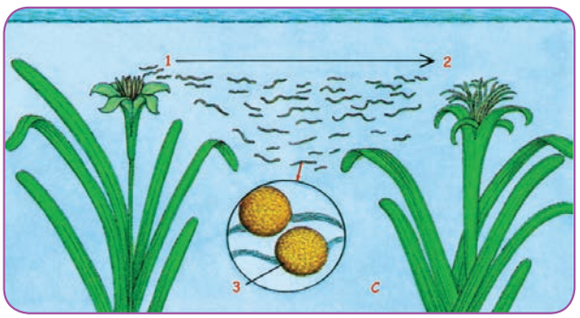
❖ Pollination by Wind (Anemophily)

The flowers pollinated by wind are mostly small in size and do not have any attractive colour, smell and nectar. The pollen grains are non-sticky, dry, light and powdery. Hence, they are easily carried by the wind. E.g. Grass, Maize, Pine.



❖ Pollination by Water (Hydrophily)

The flowers of water plants are not colourful and they have no nectar. Pollen grains of these plants have mucilaginous covering to protect them from getting wet. They float in water and reach the other plant. E.g. Vallisneria, Hydrilla, Zosteria.



❖ Pollination by Insects (Entamophily)

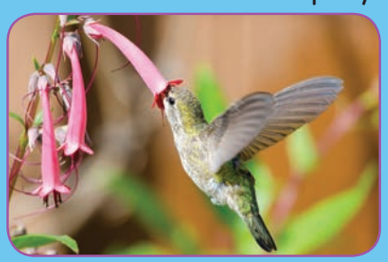
This is the most common type of pollination in plants like sunflower, ladies finger, brinjal and pumpkin. Some flowers are large in size and they have sweet smell. Some of these flowers produce nectar. They attact insects like butterflies and honey bees.





Do you know?

Fruit bats, humming birds and ants may also act as pollinating agents. Pollination by birds is known as Ornithophily.





Activity 2

Classify the plants based on the pollination methods.

Vallisneria, Hydrilla, Sunflower, Grass, Brinjal, Maize, Pumpkin.

Hydrophily	Entamophily	Anemophily